

tests/pre_build_verification.sh — operator guide

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-07-01T00:00:00Z **Authority:** Helix Constitution §11.4.35 (inheritance gate), §11.4 (pre-build verification — no CI/CD, no git hooks; CLAUDE.md Hard Stop #1), §1.1 (paired-mutation discipline for future gates)

Companion (§11.4.18) to the in-source documentation block at the top of the script.

Overview / Purpose

The **manual pre-build / pre-merge gate runner** — the single entry point the build/test pipeline invokes BEFORE a build or merge. The project Constitution bans CI/CD and git hooks (CLAUDE.md Hard Stop #1), so this enforcement lives as a script target invoked manually (or by tests/run-tests.sh) instead of a pipeline. Today it runs one gate — the constitution-inheritance gate — and is the designated place to append further pre-build gates as the project grows (each new gate must carry a paired §1.1 mutation).

Usage

```
bash tests/pre_build_verification.sh
```

No flags, no arguments.

Inputs

None. All paths are derived from the script's own location (`${BASH_SOURCE[0]}`).

Outputs

- A banner, a >>> gate: constitution inheritance line, the delegated gate's own PASS/FAIL output, and a final === pre-build verification summary: PASS|FAIL === line.

- Exit 0 — all gates passed; exit 1 — a gate failed (rc is set to 1 and returned).

Side-effects

None. It delegates to the read-only inheritance gate and never mutates the tree.

Dependencies

- bash (set -uo pipefail).
- tests/constitution_inheritance_gate.sh (the only gate it currently invokes).

Related scripts

- tests/constitution_inheritance_gate.sh — the gate this runner invokes (see docs/scripts/constitution_inheritance_gate.md).
- tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh — the comprehensive host-side inheritance test (superset of the gate).
- tests/run-tests.sh — the broader structural + regression suite, which also runs the inheritance gate as a pre-flight step.

Last verified

2026-07-01 — documented from source. The script is a thin aggregator: it runs constitution_inheritance_gate.sh and reports PASS/FAIL. Not executed here (the conductor runs the live gate).